THE SECOND EPISTLE OF PAUL
TO THE CORINTHIANS

2 CORINTHIANS

1 Paul, an apostle of Christ Jesus by the will of God, and
Timothy our brother,

To the church of God that is at Corinth, with all the saints
who are in the whole of Achaia:

[2]Grace to you and peace from God our Father and the Lord
Jesus Christ.

[3]Blessed be the God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ,
the Father of mercies and God of all comfort, [4]who comforts
us in all our affliction, so that we may be able to comfort those
who are in any affliction, with the comfort with which we
ourselves are comforted by God. [5]For as we share abundantly
in Christ's sufferings, so through Christ we share abundantly
in comfort too. [6]If we are afflicted, it is for your comfort and
salvation; and if we are comforted, it is for your comfort,
which you experience when you patiently endure the same
sufferings that we suffer. [7]Our hope for you is unshaken, for
we know that as you share in our sufferings, you will also
share in our comfort.

[8]For we do not want you to be unaware, brothers, of the
affliction we experienced in Asia. For we were so utterly bur-
dened beyond our strength that we despaired of life itself.
[9]Indeed, we felt that we had received the sentence of death.
But that was to make us rely not on ourselves but on God who
raises the dead. [10]He delivered us from such a deadly peril, and

he will deliver us. On him we have set our hope that he will
deliver us again. [11] You also must help us by prayer, so that
many will give thanks on our behalf for the blessing granted
us through the prayers of many.

[12] For our boast is this, the testimony of our conscience,
that we behaved in the world with simplicity and godly sin-
cerity, not by earthly wisdom but by the grace of God, and
supremely so toward you. [13] For we are not writing to you any-
thing other than what you read and understand and I hope
you will fully understand — [14] just as you did partially under-
stand us — that on the day of our Lord Jesus you will boast of
us as we will boast of you.

[15] Because I was sure of this, I wanted to come to you first, so
that you might have a second experience of grace. [16] I wanted
to visit you on my way to Macedonia, and to come back to
you from Macedonia and have you send me on my way to
Judea. [17] Was I vacillating when I wanted to do this? Do I make
my plans according to the flesh, ready to say "Yes, yes" and
"No, no" at the same time? [18] As surely as God is faithful, our
word to you has not been Yes and No. [19] For the Son of God,
Jesus Christ, whom we proclaimed among you, Silvanus and
Timothy and I, was not Yes and No, but in him it is always Yes.
[20] For all the promises of God find their Yes in him. That is why
it is through him that we utter our Amen to God for his glory.
[21] And it is God who establishes us with you in Christ, and has
anointed us, [22] and who has also put his seal on us and given us
his Spirit in our hearts as a guarantee.

[23] But I call God to witness against me — it was to spare you

that I refrained from coming again to Corinth. [24] Not that we
lord it over your faith, but we work with you for your joy, for
you stand firm in your faith.

2 For I made up my mind not to make another painful visit
to you. [2] For if I cause you pain, who is there to make me glad
but the one whom I have pained? [3] And I wrote as I did, so that
when I came I might not suffer pain from those who should
have made me rejoice, for I felt sure of all of you, that my joy
would be the joy of you all. [4] For I wrote to you out of much
affliction and anguish of heart and with many tears, not to
cause you pain but to let you know the abundant love that I
have for you.

[5] Now if anyone has caused pain, he has caused it not to
me, but in some measure — not to put it too severely — to all
of you. [6] For such a one, this punishment by the majority is
enough, [7] so you should rather turn to forgive and comfort
him, or he may be overwhelmed by excessive sorrow. [8] So I
beg you to reaffirm your love for him. [9] For this is why I wrote,
that I might test you and know whether you are obedient in
everything. [10] Anyone whom you forgive, I also forgive. Indeed,
what I have forgiven, if I have forgiven anything, has been for
your sake in the presence of Christ, [11] so that we would not be
outwitted by Satan; for we are not ignorant of his designs.

[12] When I came to Troas to preach the gospel of Christ, even
though a door was opened for me in the Lord, [13] my spirit was
not at rest because I did not find my brother Titus there. So I
took leave of them and went on to Macedonia.

[14] But thanks be to God, who in Christ always leads us in

triumphal procession, and through us spreads the fragrance
of the knowledge of him everywhere. [15] For we are the aroma
of Christ to God among those who are being saved and among
those who are perishing, [16] to one a fragrance from death to
death, to the other a fragrance from life to life. Who is suffi-
cient for these things? [17] For we are not, like so many, peddlers
of God's word, but as men of sincerity, as commissioned by
God, in the sight of God we speak in Christ.

3 Are we beginning to commend ourselves again? Or do we
need, as some do, letters of recommendation to you, or from
you? [2] You yourselves are our letter of recommendation, writ-
ten on our hearts, to be known and read by all. [3] And you show
that you are a letter from Christ delivered by us, written not
with ink but with the Spirit of the living God, not on tablets
of stone but on tablets of human hearts.

[4] Such is the confidence that we have through Christ
toward God. [5] Not that we are sufficient in ourselves to claim
anything as coming from us, but our sufficiency is from God,
[6] who has made us sufficient to be ministers of a new covenant,
not of the letter but of the Spirit. For the letter kills, but the
Spirit gives life.

[7] Now if the ministry of death, carved in letters on stone,
came with such glory that the Israelites could not gaze at
Moses' face because of its glory, which was being brought to
an end, [8] will not the ministry of the Spirit have even more
glory? [9] For if there was glory in the ministry of condemna-
tion, the ministry of righteousness must far exceed it in glory.
[10] Indeed, in this case, what once had glory has come to have no

glory at all, because of the glory that surpasses it. [11] For if what
was being brought to an end came with glory, much more
will what is permanent have glory.

[12] Since we have such a hope, we are very bold, [13] not like
Moses, who would put a veil over his face so that the Israelites
might not gaze at the outcome of what was being brought
to an end. [14] But their minds were hardened. For to this day,
when they read the old covenant, that same veil remains
unlifted, because only through Christ is it taken away. [15] Yes,
to this day whenever Moses is read a veil lies over their hearts.
[16] But when one turns to the Lord, the veil is removed. [17] Now
the Lord is the Spirit, and where the Spirit of the Lord is, there
is freedom. [18] And we all, with unveiled face, beholding the
glory of the Lord, are being transformed into the same image
from one degree of glory to another. For this comes from the
Lord who is the Spirit.

4 Therefore, having this ministry by the mercy of God, we
do not lose heart. [2] But we have renounced disgraceful, under-
handed ways. We refuse to practice cunning or to tamper with
God's word, but by the open statement of the truth we would
commend ourselves to everyone's conscience in the sight of
God. [3] And even if our gospel is veiled, it is veiled to those who
are perishing. [4] In their case the god of this world has blinded
the minds of the unbelievers, to keep them from seeing the
light of the gospel of the glory of Christ, who is the image of
God. [5] For what we proclaim is not ourselves, but Jesus Christ
as Lord, with ourselves as your servants for Jesus' sake. [6] For
God, who said, "Let light shine out of darkness," has shone in

our hearts to give the light of the knowledge of the glory of
God in the face of Jesus Christ.

[7] But we have this treasure in jars of clay, to show that
the surpassing power belongs to God and not to us. [8] We are
afflicted in every way, but not crushed; perplexed, but not
driven to despair; [9] persecuted, but not forsaken; struck down,
but not destroyed; [10] always carrying in the body the death of
Jesus, so that the life of Jesus may also be manifested in our
bodies. [11] For we who live are always being given over to death
for Jesus' sake, so that the life of Jesus also may be manifested
in our mortal flesh. [12] So death is at work in us, but life in you.

[13] Since we have the same spirit of faith according to what
has been written, "I believed, and so I spoke," we also believe,
and so we also speak, [14] knowing that he who raised the Lord
Jesus will raise us also with Jesus and bring us with you into
his presence. [15] For it is all for your sake, so that as grace extends
to more and more people it may increase thanksgiving, to the
glory of God.

[16] So we do not lose heart. Though our outer self is wasting
away, our inner self is being renewed day by day. [17] For this light
momentary affliction is preparing for us an eternal weight of
glory beyond all comparison, [18] as we look not to the things that
are seen but to the things that are unseen. For the things that
are seen are transient, but the things that are unseen are eternal.

5 For we know that if the tent that is our earthly home is
destroyed, we have a building from God, a house not made
with hands, eternal in the heavens. [2] For in this tent we groan,
longing to put on our heavenly dwelling, [3] if indeed by putting

it on we may not be found naked. [4] For while we are still in
this tent, we groan, being burdened—not that we would be
unclothed, but that we would be further clothed, so that what
is mortal may be swallowed up by life. [5] He who has prepared
us for this very thing is God, who has given us the Spirit as a
guarantee.

[6] So we are always of good courage. We know that while we
are at home in the body we are away from the Lord, [7] for we
walk by faith, not by sight. [8] Yes, we are of good courage, and
we would rather be away from the body and at home with the
Lord. [9] So whether we are at home or away, we make it our aim
to please him. [10] For we must all appear before the judgment
seat of Christ, so that each one may receive what is due for
what he has done in the body, whether good or evil.

[11] Therefore, knowing the fear of the Lord, we persuade
others. But what we are is known to God, and I hope it is
known also to your conscience. [12] We are not commending
ourselves to you again but giving you cause to boast about
us, so that you may be able to answer those who boast about
outward appearance and not about what is in the heart. [13] For
if we are beside ourselves, it is for God; if we are in our right
mind, it is for you. [14] For the love of Christ controls us, because
we have concluded this: that one has died for all, therefore all
have died; [15] and he died for all, that those who live might no
longer live for themselves but for him who for their sake died
and was raised.

[16] From now on, therefore, we regard no one according to
the flesh. Even though we once regarded Christ according

to the flesh, we regard him thus no longer. [17] Therefore, if
anyone is in Christ, he is a new creation. The old has passed
away; behold, the new has come. [18] All this is from God, who
through Christ reconciled us to himself and gave us the
ministry of reconciliation; [19] that is, in Christ God was rec-
onciling the world to himself, not counting their trespasses
against them, and entrusting to us the message of recon-
ciliation. [20] Therefore, we are ambassadors for Christ, God
making his appeal through us. We implore you on behalf of
Christ, be reconciled to God. [21] For our sake he made him to
be sin who knew no sin, so that in him we might become the
righteousness of God.

6 Working together with him, then, we appeal to you not to
receive the grace of God in vain. [2] For he says,

"In a favorable time I listened to you,
and in a day of salvation I have helped you."

Behold, now is the favorable time; behold, now is the day of
salvation. [3] We put no obstacle in anyone's way, so that no
fault may be found with our ministry, [4] but as servants of God
we commend ourselves in every way: by great endurance, in
afflictions, hardships, calamities, [5] beatings, imprisonments,
riots, labors, sleepless nights, hunger; [6] by purity, knowledge,
patience, kindness, the Holy Spirit, genuine love; [7] by truth-
ful speech, and the power of God; with the weapons of righ-
teousness for the right hand and for the left; [8] through honor
and dishonor, through slander and praise. We are treated as
impostors, and yet are true; [9] as unknown, and yet well known;

as dying, and behold, we live; as punished, and yet not killed;
[10] as sorrowful, yet always rejoicing; as poor, yet making many
rich; as having nothing, yet possessing everything.

[11] We have spoken freely to you, Corinthians; our heart is
wide open. [12] You are not restricted by us, but you are restricted
in your own affections. [13] In return (I speak as to children)
widen your hearts also.

[14] Do not be unequally yoked with unbelievers. For what
partnership has righteousness with lawlessness? Or what fel-
lowship has light with darkness? [15] What accord has Christ
with Belial? Or what portion does a believer share with an
unbeliever? [16] What agreement has the temple of God with
idols? For we are the temple of the living God; as God said,

"I will make my dwelling among them and walk
among them,
and I will be their God,
and they shall be my people.
17 Therefore go out from their midst,
and be separate from them, says the Lord,
and touch no unclean thing;
then I will welcome you,
18 and I will be a father to you,
and you shall be sons and daughters to me,
says the Lord Almighty."

7 Since we have these promises, beloved, let us cleanse our-
selves from every defilement of body and spirit, bringing
holiness to completion in the fear of God.

[2]Make room in your hearts for us. We have wronged no
one, we have corrupted no one, we have taken advantage of
no one. [3]I do not say this to condemn you, for I said before
that you are in our hearts, to die together and to live together.
[4]I am acting with great boldness toward you; I have great
pride in you; I am filled with comfort. In all our affliction,
I am overflowing with joy.

[5]For even when we came into Macedonia, our bodies had
no rest, but we were afflicted at every turn—fighting without
and fear within. [6]But God, who comforts the downcast, com-
forted us by the coming of Titus, [7]and not only by his coming
but also by the comfort with which he was comforted by you,
as he told us of your longing, your mourning, your zeal for
me, so that I rejoiced still more. [8]For even if I made you grieve
with my letter, I do not regret it—though I did regret it, for
I see that that letter grieved you, though only for a while. [9]As
it is, I rejoice, not because you were grieved, but because you
were grieved into repenting. For you felt a godly grief, so that
you suffered no loss through us.

[10]For godly grief produces a repentance that leads to sal-
vation without regret, whereas worldly grief produces death.
[11]For see what earnestness this godly grief has produced in
you, but also what eagerness to clear yourselves, what indig-
nation, what fear, what longing, what zeal, what punish-
ment! At every point you have proved yourselves innocent in
the matter. [12]So although I wrote to you, it was not for the sake
of the one who did the wrong, nor for the sake of the one who
suffered the wrong, but in order that your earnestness for us

might be revealed to you in the sight of God. [13]Therefore we
are comforted.

And besides our own comfort, we rejoiced still more at the
joy of Titus, because his spirit has been refreshed by you all.
[14]For whatever boasts I made to him about you, I was not put
to shame. But just as everything we said to you was true, so
also our boasting before Titus has proved true. [15]And his affec-
tion for you is even greater, as he remembers the obedience
of you all, how you received him with fear and trembling.
[16]I rejoice, because I have complete confidence in you.

8 We want you to know, brothers, about the grace of God
that has been given among the churches of Macedonia, [2]for
in a severe test of affliction, their abundance of joy and their
extreme poverty have overflowed in a wealth of generosity on
their part. [3]For they gave according to their means, as I can
testify, and beyond their means, of their own accord, [4]beg-
ging us earnestly for the favor of taking part in the relief
of the saints—[5]and this, not as we expected, but they gave
themselves first to the Lord and then by the will of God to
us. [6]Accordingly, we urged Titus that as he had started, so he
should complete among you this act of grace. [7]But as you excel
in everything—in faith, in speech, in knowledge, in all ear-
nestness, and in our love for you—see that you excel in this
act of grace also.

[8]I say this not as a command, but to prove by the earnest-
ness of others that your love also is genuine. [9]For you know
the grace of our Lord Jesus Christ, that though he was rich,
yet for your sake he became poor, so that you by his poverty

might become rich. [10]And in this matter I give my judgment:
this benefits you, who a year ago started not only to do this
work but also to desire to do it. [11]So now finish doing it as
well, so that your readiness in desiring it may be matched by
your completing it out of what you have. [12]For if the readiness
is there, it is acceptable according to what a person has, not
according to what he does not have. [13]For I do not mean that
others should be eased and you burdened, but that as a mat-
ter of fairness [14]your abundance at the present time should
supply their need, so that their abundance may supply your
need, that there may be fairness. [15]As it is written, "Whoever
gathered much had nothing left over, and whoever gathered
little had no lack."

[16]But thanks be to God, who put into the heart of Titus
the same earnest care I have for you. [17]For he not only accepted
our appeal, but being himself very earnest he is going to you
of his own accord. [18]With him we are sending the brother who
is famous among all the churches for his preaching of the
gospel. [19]And not only that, but he has been appointed by the
churches to travel with us as we carry out this act of grace that
is being ministered by us, for the glory of the Lord himself
and to show our good will. [20]We take this course so that no one
should blame us about this generous gift that is being admin-
istered by us, [21]for we aim at what is honorable not only in
the Lord's sight but also in the sight of man. [22]And with them
we are sending our brother whom we have often tested and
found earnest in many matters, but who is now more earnest
than ever because of his great confidence in you. [23]As for Titus,

he is my partner and fellow worker for your benefit. And as for
our brothers, they are messengers of the churches, the glory of
Christ. [24]So give proof before the churches of your love and of
our boasting about you to these men.

9 Now it is superfluous for me to write to you about the
ministry for the saints, [2]for I know your readiness, of which
I boast about you to the people of Macedonia, saying that
Achaia has been ready since last year. And your zeal has stirred
up most of them. [3]But I am sending the brothers so that our
boasting about you may not prove empty in this matter, so
that you may be ready, as I said you would be. [4]Otherwise, if
some Macedonians come with me and find that you are not
ready, we would be humiliated—to say nothing of you—
for being so confident. [5]So I thought it necessary to urge the
brothers to go on ahead to you and arrange in advance for the
gift you have promised, so that it may be ready as a willing
gift, not as an exaction.

[6]The point is this: whoever sows sparingly will also reap
sparingly, and whoever sows bountifully will also reap boun-
tifully. [7]Each one must give as he has decided in his heart, not
reluctantly or under compulsion, for God loves a cheerful
giver. [8]And God is able to make all grace abound to you, so
that having all sufficiency in all things at all times, you may
abound in every good work. [9]As it is written,

"He has distributed freely, he has given to the
poor;
his righteousness endures forever."

[10]He who supplies seed to the sower and bread for food will
supply and multiply your seed for sowing and increase the
harvest of your righteousness. [11]You will be enriched in every
way to be generous in every way, which through us will pro-
duce thanksgiving to God. [12]For the ministry of this service
is not only supplying the needs of the saints but is also over-
flowing in many thanksgivings to God. [13]By their approval of
this service, they will glorify God because of your submission
that comes from your confession of the gospel of Christ, and
the generosity of your contribution for them and for all oth-
ers, [14]while they long for you and pray for you, because of the
surpassing grace of God upon you. [15]Thanks be to God for his
inexpressible gift!

10 I, Paul, myself entreat you, by the meekness and gentle-
ness of Christ—I who am humble when face to face with you,
but bold toward you when I am away!—[2]I beg of you that
when I am present I may not have to show boldness with such
confidence as I count on showing against some who suspect
us of walking according to the flesh. [3]For though we walk
in the flesh, we are not waging war according to the flesh.
[4]For the weapons of our warfare are not of the flesh but have
divine power to destroy strongholds. [5]We destroy arguments
and every lofty opinion raised against the knowledge of God,
and take every thought captive to obey Christ, [6]being ready to
punish every disobedience, when your obedience is complete.

[7]Look at what is before your eyes. If anyone is confident that
he is Christ's, let him remind himself that just as he is Christ's,
so also are we. [8]For even if I boast a little too much of our

authority, which the Lord gave for building you up and not for
destroying you, I will not be ashamed. [9]I do not want to appear
to be frightening you with my letters. [10]For they say, "His let-
ters are weighty and strong, but his bodily presence is weak,
and his speech of no account." [11]Let such a person understand
that what we say by letter when absent, we do when present.
[12]Not that we dare to classify or compare ourselves with some
of those who are commending themselves. But when they
measure themselves by one another and compare themselves
with one another, they are without understanding.

[13]But we will not boast beyond limits, but will boast only
with regard to the area of influence God assigned to us, to
reach even to you. [14]For we are not overextending ourselves,
as though we did not reach you. For we were the first to come
all the way to you with the gospel of Christ. [15]We do not boast
beyond limit in the labors of others. But our hope is that as
your faith increases, our area of influence among you may be
greatly enlarged, [16]so that we may preach the gospel in lands
beyond you, without boasting of work already done in anoth-
er's area of influence. [17]"Let the one who boasts, boast in the
Lord." [18]For it is not the one who commends himself who is
approved, but the one whom the Lord commends.

11 I wish you would bear with me in a little foolishness.
Do bear with me! [2]For I feel a divine jealousy for you, since I
betrothed you to one husband, to present you as a pure vir-
gin to Christ. [3]But I am afraid that as the serpent deceived
Eve by his cunning, your thoughts will be led astray from a
sincere and pure devotion to Christ. [4]For if someone comes

and proclaims another Jesus than the one we proclaimed, or
if you receive a different spirit from the one you received, or if
you accept a different gospel from the one you accepted, you
put up with it readily enough. [5]Indeed, I consider that I am
not in the least inferior to these super-apostles. [6]Even if I am
unskilled in speaking, I am not so in knowledge; indeed, in
every way we have made this plain to you in all things.

[7]Or did I commit a sin in humbling myself so that you
might be exalted, because I preached God's gospel to you free
of charge? [8]I robbed other churches by accepting support
from them in order to serve you. [9]And when I was with you
and was in need, I did not burden anyone, for the brothers
who came from Macedonia supplied my need. So I refrained
and will refrain from burdening you in any way. [10]As the truth
of Christ is in me, this boasting of mine will not be silenced
in the regions of Achaia. [11]And why? Because I do not love you?
God knows I do!

[12]And what I am doing I will continue to do, in order to
undermine the claim of those who would like to claim that
in their boasted mission they work on the same terms as we
do. [13]For such men are false apostles, deceitful workmen, dis-
guising themselves as apostles of Christ. [14]And no wonder, for
even Satan disguises himself as an angel of light. [15]So it is no
surprise if his servants, also, disguise themselves as servants of
righteousness. Their end will correspond to their deeds.

[16]I repeat, let no one think me foolish. But even if you do,
accept me as a fool, so that I too may boast a little. [17]What I
am saying with this boastful confidence, I say not as the Lord

would but as a fool. [18]Since many boast according to the flesh,
I too will boast. [19]For you gladly bear with fools, being wise
yourselves! [20]For you bear it if someone makes slaves of you,
or devours you, or takes advantage of you, or puts on airs, or
strikes you in the face. [21]To my shame, I must say, we were too
weak for that!

But whatever anyone else dares to boast of—I am speak-
ing as a fool—I also dare to boast of that. [22]Are they Hebrews?
So am I. Are they Israelites? So am I. Are they offspring of
Abraham? So am I. [23]Are they servants of Christ? I am a better
one—I am talking like a madman—with far greater labors,
far more imprisonments, with countless beatings, and often
near death. [24]Five times I received at the hands of the Jews the
forty lashes less one. [25]Three times I was beaten with rods.
Once I was stoned. Three times I was shipwrecked; a night
and a day I was adrift at sea; [26]on frequent journeys, in dan-
ger from rivers, danger from robbers, danger from my own
people, danger from Gentiles, danger in the city, danger in
the wilderness, danger at sea, danger from false brothers; [27]in
toil and hardship, through many a sleepless night, in hunger
and thirst, often without food, in cold and exposure. [28]And,
apart from other things, there is the daily pressure on me of
my anxiety for all the churches. [29]Who is weak, and I am not
weak? Who is made to fall, and I am not indignant?

[30]If I must boast, I will boast of the things that show my
weakness. [31]The God and Father of the Lord Jesus, he who is
blessed forever, knows that I am not lying. [32]At Damascus,
the governor under King Aretas was guarding the city of

Damascus in order to seize me, [33]but I was let down in a basket
through a window in the wall and escaped his hands.

12 I must go on boasting. Though there is nothing to be
gained by it, I will go on to visions and revelations of the
Lord. [2]I know a man in Christ who fourteen years ago was
caught up to the third heaven—whether in the body or out
of the body I do not know, God knows. [3]And I know that this
man was caught up into paradise—whether in the body or
out of the body I do not know, God knows—[4]and he heard
things that cannot be told, which man may not utter. [5]On
behalf of this man I will boast, but on my own behalf I will
not boast, except of my weaknesses—[6]though if I should
wish to boast, I would not be a fool, for I would be speaking
the truth; but I refrain from it, so that no one may think
more of me than he sees in me or hears from me. [7]So to
keep me from becoming conceited because of the surpass-
ing greatness of the revelations, a thorn was given me in the
flesh, a messenger of Satan to harass me, to keep me from
becoming conceited. [8]Three times I pleaded with the Lord
about this, that it should leave me. [9]But he said to me, "My
grace is sufficient for you, for my power is made perfect in
weakness." Therefore I will boast all the more gladly of my
weaknesses, so that the power of Christ may rest upon me.
[10]For the sake of Christ, then, I am content with weaknesses,
insults, hardships, persecutions, and calamities. For when I
am weak, then I am strong.

[11]I have been a fool! You forced me to it, for I ought to have
been commended by you. For I was not at all inferior to these

super-apostles, even though I am nothing. [12]The signs of a true
apostle were performed among you with utmost patience,
with signs and wonders and mighty works. [13]For in what were
you less favored than the rest of the churches, except that I
myself did not burden you? Forgive me this wrong!

[14]Here for the third time I am ready to come to you. And
I will not be a burden, for I seek not what is yours but you.
For children are not obligated to save up for their parents, but
parents for their children. [15]I will most gladly spend and be
spent for your souls. If I love you more, am I to be loved less?
[16]But granting that I myself did not burden you, I was crafty,
you say, and got the better of you by deceit. [17]Did I take advan-
tage of you through any of those whom I sent to you? [18]I urged
Titus to go, and sent the brother with him. Did Titus take
advantage of you? Did we not act in the same spirit? Did we
not take the same steps?

[19]Have you been thinking all along that we have been
defending ourselves to you? It is in the sight of God that we
have been speaking in Christ, and all for your upbuilding,
beloved. [20]For I fear that perhaps when I come I may find you
not as I wish, and that you may find me not as you wish—that
perhaps there may be quarreling, jealousy, anger, hostility,
slander, gossip, conceit, and disorder. [21]I fear that when I come
again my God may humble me before you, and I may have to
mourn over many of those who sinned earlier and have not
repented of the impurity, sexual immorality, and sensuality
that they have practiced.

13 This is the third time I am coming to you. Every charge

must be established by the evidence of two or three witnesses.
[2]I warned those who sinned before and all the others, and I
warn them now while absent, as I did when present on my
second visit, that if I come again I will not spare them—[3]since
you seek proof that Christ is speaking in me. He is not weak
in dealing with you, but is powerful among you. [4]For he was
crucified in weakness, but lives by the power of God. For we
also are weak in him, but in dealing with you we will live with
him by the power of God.

[5]Examine yourselves, to see whether you are in the faith.
Test yourselves. Or do you not realize this about yourselves,
that Jesus Christ is in you?—unless indeed you fail to meet
the test! [6]I hope you will find out that we have not failed the
test. [7]But we pray to God that you may not do wrong—not
that we may appear to have met the test, but that you may
do what is right, though we may seem to have failed. [8]For we
cannot do anything against the truth, but only for the truth.
[9]For we are glad when we are weak and you are strong. Your
restoration is what we pray for. [10]For this reason I write these
things while I am away from you, that when I come I may not
have to be severe in my use of the authority that the Lord has
given me for building up and not for tearing down.

[11]Finally, brothers, rejoice. Aim for restoration, comfort
one another, agree with one another, live in peace; and the
God of love and peace will be with you. [12]Greet one another
with a holy kiss. [13]All the saints greet you.

[14]The grace of the Lord Jesus Christ and the love of God
and the fellowship of the Holy Spirit be with you all.